

RAR files make it attractive for those doing a lot of downloading. The lack of even basic facilities to respond to text messages makes it absolutely worthless for those who do no downloading.

7.1.4 Other Clients

We shall briefly discuss the NG handling capabilities of two popular e-mail clients—Outlook Express and Thunderbird.

Outlook Express 6

In Outlook Express (OE), a News Account can be added just like adding an e-mail account. Relevant details about the server should be provided. After the setup, you are asked whether to check for NGs. The list of NGs is then provided. A user can search for NGs having specific terms from the Search box. The lack of a message count is disappointing. Right-clicking on the selected NG allows you to subscribe to it. Subscribed NGs appear in the left panel under the NNTP server name. Selecting the NG will cause the message headers in it to be downloaded. Selecting a message header will cause the message body to be downloaded. Neat.

Message management options are similar to those seen in other clients—messages can be marked read, and clicking on reply will pop up the familiar message creation window. In case of multi part messages, selecting the parts and right clicking will reveal the “Merge and Decode” option which recreates the original file from the parts.

The maximum number of headers to be simultaneously downloaded can be set from the Options under the Tools menu. The automatic downloading of the body when selecting the header can be disabled here.

OE is capable of handling multi part messages and allows filters to be set to check the inflow of spam. The folder where messages are stored can be compressed to free space



Creating a news account in OE is easy